USING DATA TO DRIVE BUSINESS PERFORMANCE · PREPARED FOR CENGAGE · OCTOBER 2026

Full industry research

Nimrod Dvir, PhD · ndvir@albany.edu · 646-244-2338 · Massry School of Business, University at Albany, SUNY

Online version: https://database-textbook.dimapublishing.com/cengage-prospectus-oyb70aaf/

SKILLS AND WORK

Labor, employer and industry research

What we researched

A 2026 analysis by 365 Data Science of 1,000 Indeed USA data analyst postings (855 relevant), U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics projections for 2025–35, and the World Economic Forum employer survey.

What employers ask for

We looked at what employers ask for in the skills this book teaches.

52.9%
OF JOB POSTINGS

U.S. data analyst job postings that ask for SQL

Of 855 relevant postings in a vendor analysis of 1,000 Indeed USA listings. Python appears in 31.2%, Power BI in 29.0% and Tableau in 26.2%.

Source: 365 Data Science [9]

+35%
GROWTH, 2025 TO 2035

Projected growth in data scientist jobs

Against 3% for all occupations. Median pay: $120,230 a year (May 2025).

Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics [10]

+9%
GROWTH, 2025 TO 2035

Projected growth in database architect jobs

Median pay: $139,500 a year (May 2025).

Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics [11]

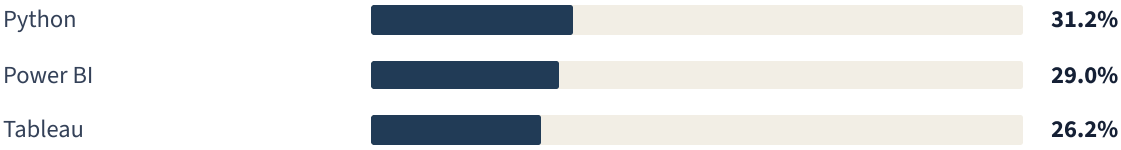
About two-thirds
OF EMPLOYERS WORLDWIDE

Plan to hire for AI skills

AI and big data are the fastest-growing skills employers report.

Source: World Economic Forum [12]





Share of 855 U.S. data analyst job postings that list each skill.

Evidence	Finding	Courseware implication
BLS: data scientists, 2025–35	**35% projected growth**, compared with 3% for all occupations; about **24,800 openings annually**. [L1]	Connect data preparation and queries to interpretation, communication, and decisions.
BLS: database architects / administrators, 2025–35	Architects: **9%** growth. Administrators: **0%**. Combined: about **7,300 openings annually**. [L2]	Retain modeling, quality, permissions, backup, and system judgment alongside analytics.
WEF: Future of Jobs Report 2025	Survey of **1,000+ employers**, representing **14 million+ workers** across **55 economies**; roughly **7 in 10** identify analytical thinking as essential. [L3]	Require students to explain a result, test its reliability, and justify an action.
WEF: skills outlook to 2030	AI and big data lead the skills employers expect to grow fastest. [L3]	Integrate responsible AI use, verification, data provenance, and limits across the learning experience.

MAIN CONCLUSION

SQL, reporting and judgment belong together. Students need to produce a result, establish that it is reliable, and communicate what an organization should do with it.

Job-posting shares describe this sample of 855 postings, not all U.S. hiring. BLS growth projections (the change in employment, 2025–35) and annual openings are separate measures: openings include replacement hiring, so they can be substantial even where growth is flat. Global employer expectations (WEF) are distinct from U.S. job-posting requirements.

SOURCES AND SCOPE

References

Market, employment and curriculum references

9. 365 Data Science. (2026, April 28). *The data analyst job market in 2026: Research on 1,000 job postings* (Indeed USA; 855 relevant postings). Vendor analysis, not peer reviewed. Link

10. U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. (2026). *Occupational Outlook Handbook: Data scientists*. Link

11. U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. (2026). *Occupational Outlook Handbook: Database administrators and architects*. Link

12. World Economic Forum. (2025). *The Future of Jobs Report 2025*. Link

Research archive, textbook, labor and platform references

[L1]

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Data Scientists ↗

Current Occupational Outlook Handbook read October 25, 2026. Projects 35% employment growth, 2025-2035; all occupations 3%.

[L2]

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Database Administrators and Architects ↗

Current Occupational Outlook Handbook read October 25, 2026. Architects 9%; administrators 0%; combined 4%, 2025-2035. Rounded percentages.

[L3]

World Economic Forum: Future of Jobs Report 2025 ↗

Employer expectations for 2025-2030: analytical thinking essential to about seven in ten responding companies; AI and big data lead skills expected to grow. Global employer survey, not U.S. hiring requirements.
